

FEDERAL MARITIME COMMISSION
Office of Administrative Law Judges

IWG INTERNATIONAL WOOD GROUP OF SC AND
HONEST TRADING INTERNATIONAL LLC, *Complainants*

v.

DB SCHENKER USA, INC., *Respondent*.

DOCKET NO. 25-16

Served: March 24, 2026

ORDER OF: Richard AMBROW, *Administrative Law Judge*.

ORDER ACCEPTING COMPLAINANTS' OPENING BRIEF, AND SETTING REMAINING SCHEDULE

On August 7, 2025, the Commission issued a Notice of Filing of Complaint and Assignment ("Notice") for this proceeding. Respondent filed Respondent's Verified Answer and Affirmative Defenses on September 22, 2025.

Complainants' Opening Brief, proposed findings of fact and appendix were due March 19, 2026. Complainants did not timely file their brief and accompanying documents. On March 20, 2026, I issued an Order for Complainants to Show Cause No Later than March 26, 2026, requiring Complainants to explain whether they needed additional time to file their opening brief.

Later in the day on March 20, 2026, the owner of Complainant IWG International Wood Group of SC ("IWG") sent an email to the Office of Administrative Law Judges stating that he had a family emergency. On March 24, 2026, Complainants filed Complainants' Post-Hearing Brief, Proposed Findings of Fact, and Appendix ("Complainants' Opening Brief").

I accept the representation of IWG's owner, and I find that good cause exists for the untimely opening brief. I note that the opening brief is signed by IWG's owner, and a manager of Honest Trading International, LLC ("Honest Trading"). Therefore, I am satisfied that Complainants' Opening Brief was filed jointly.¹

¹ I note that the Verified Complaint was jointly signed by IWG's owner and Honest Trading's Manager. In addition, the December 1, 2025, Joint Status Report and Proposed Scheduling Order was signed by individuals on behalf of each Complainant. A party may appear by an officer, partner, or regular employee of the party. (46 C.F.R. § 502.21). To date, it appears that all documents on behalf of Complainants have been signed by employees, owners, or managers of each Complainant.

Accordingly, it is **HEREBY ORDERED** that the Complainants' Opening Brief is accepted for filing. It is

FURTHER ORDERED that Respondent's Response Brief is now due **April 24, 2026**. It is

FURTHER ORDERED that Complainants' Reply Brief is now due **May 8, 2026**.

Richard C.

Ambrow Jr -S

Richard Ambrow
Administrative Law Judge

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Ambrow Jr -S
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